

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 11, 2022, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward II Councilor James Contois
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne - Absent
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Lucas Beliveau
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Lisa Richmond, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Mooshian to accept the minutes of the April 27, 2022, City Council meeting.

Roll call:

**Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard – yes**

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard congratulated Christian Stone who was chosen as student speaker at the Plymouth State Graduate Ceremony and for completing his Master's degree.

Mayor Girard noted that National Police week and National EMS week is May 15-21st.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. MacLean reminded the City Council and the public of our budget workshop this Saturday 5/14 starting at 8:30 a.m. followed by CIP tour.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Parks and Recreation Commission

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to re-appoint Chad Myhre to Seat 4 of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard reminded the public that the Citizen's Forum allotted each individual to speak for a total of five minutes on non-agenda items.

Mike Tetu, Ward 1, stated his government is failing him if he can't get a proposal that a substantial amount of work had been put into, that will eliminate an \$85,000 deficit and charge users at the transfer station half the market rate to be put on the agenda. Mr. Tetu asked the Council that no action be taken on transfer station fees tonight.

Norm Blouin, Ward 3, explained concern for not receiving enough bids. Mr. Blouin asked the Council if the City is getting rid of the Transfer Station and if a deal was being made with Casella. Mr. Blouin stated since 1983 this town has been going downhill. Mr. Blouin also noted

if there were to be a tax increase, things will only get worse. Mr. Blouin explained he hasn't seen the Planning Department come up with a business that wants to come to Claremont from outside of town in many years. Mr. Blouin stated the tax bills are "ridiculous." Mr. Blouin stated the majority of citizens in Claremont are senior citizens. Mr. Blouin suggested the Council to take 5-10% cut in pay and then work on the budget. Mr. Blouin asked Councilor Koloski directly what we are saving the Sullivan Smokestack for, and that Mr. Blouin heard that a contractor offered the City to take the Smokestack down for \$10,000.

Mr. Blouin Citizen's forum time expired, Mayor Girard closed the citizens forum.

OLD BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

City Fee Schedule – Public Hearing

Ms. Richmond gave a review of the City Fee Schedule and started by explaining the changes to the Cemetery fees. Such as cost recovery for burials, or burials after 3 p.m. and in the winter months. The cremation fee was also increased for winter months and after 3 p.m. Monument foundations were also increased due to the increase in cost of cement.

Ms. Richmond noted other changes to the fee schedule. Under Planning and Zoning there is an increase cost in postage for abutter notification.

The Next change in the City Fee schedule Ms. Richmond reviewed was the Public Works sanitation fees. Ms. Richmond explained to the Council that Director Gleeson, Public Works Director took into consideration the fees of surrounding Transfer Stations while keeping middle ground so the department can have some additional cost recovery.

Ms. Richmond then explained the Parks and Recreation fee schedule. Ms. Richmond stated to the Council that Director Brislin had worked with the Parks and Recreation Commission to create a campaign to increase membership. Ms. Richmond stated to increase revenue the department can either increase membership or raise fees. Ms. Richmond cautioned the Council and stated the last time fees were raised a significant number of people did not renew their membership. Ms. Richmond explained this is why there isn't a change in their fee structure for this year.

Councilor Stone made a motion to strike the \$100 fee after 3pm for burials.

Mr. MacLean explained this is to recover the overtime cost and suggested waiting until the end of reviewing the fee schedule to make a motion.

Councilor Stone withdrew the motion to strike the \$100 fee After 3pm for burials.

Councilor Limoges asked if there has been any progress with making the recreation center twenty-four/seven. Ms. Richmond noted that it would be difficult to hire for early mornings and late evenings, and that these employees fall under the merit plan.

Councilor Koloski suggested it may be useful for Parks and Recreation to hire a consultant looking into the original proposed pitch of adding features such as a smoothie bar, or a baby-sitting program.

Mayor Girard opened up a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by no one for a green burial fee in the Cemetery Fee Schedule for \$300. Motion had no second, motion fails.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Koloski to strike \$100 fee for the Cemetery Fee Schedule for after 3 p.m. and winter month burials.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion failed 4-4

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Stone to add a 10% increase to all Parks and Recreation fees on page 12 of the City Fee Schedule.

Councilor Koloski stated he can't support this. Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees and suggested the new director will have ideas.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges - no

Beliveau - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - no

Motion failed 2-6

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to adopt the City Fee Schedule as presented. Councilor Contois amended motion- to add an additional \$0.15 fee per pound of waste relative to the trash bags. The amended motion was Seconded by Councilor Mooshian.

Councilor Contois stated citizens do not want to the close transfer station and added the Council is squeezing Mike Tetu out of the equation.

Councilor Koloski noted there currently is no way to measure the weight of waste without a scale.

Roll call:

Contois – yes

Stone - no

Matteau -no

Koloski - no

Limoges - no

Beliveau - no

Mooshian - yes

Girard -no

Motion failed 2-6

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to adopt the City Fee Schedule as presented.

Roll call:

Contois – no

Stone - yes

Matteau -yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard -yes

Motion carried 7-1

WHEREAS, the City wishes to accept funds from the New Hampshire Drinking Water State Revolving Loan Fund (DWSRF) and American Rescue Plan Act of 2021 (ARPA) grant funds to complete projects relating to the removal of lead lines and otherwise deficient lines from the Claremont Water System; and

WHEREAS, in accordance with the “2021 Award Plan”, the NH Drinking Water & Groundwater Advisory Commission requires that a funding application for the Construction Projects Assistance Program include an “authority to submit application” to meet the threshold for project readiness; and

WHEREAS, these actions are in response to the application acceptance; and

WHEREAS, the City presently has lead components in the water lines that provide service to the residents of Claremont; and

WHEREAS, the City wishes to protect the health and wellbeing of its citizens by replacing all the lead water lines; and

WHEREAS, the City Lead Service and Water Main Replacement has been listed on the Drinking Water State Revolving Loan Fund (DWSRF) Project Priority List for financial assistance:

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council to authorize the city manager, or his designees, to take such actions as may be necessary to apply, accept, and expend \$1,554,000 from the NH Drinking Water State Revolving Fund and accept \$1,036,000 from the American Rescue Plan Act of 2021 (ARPA) and enter into grant and loan agreements.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the city manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents, including the loan and agreements, related to this resolution, and the city treasurer is hereby authorized to act on behalf of the Water Enterprise Fund by signing monetary disbursements. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Director Gleeson joined City Council via Zoom and shared a PowerPoint presentation. Mr. Gleeson gave background information for this resolution and stated the final application deadline in June. Mr. Gleeson also noted this coordinates well with our “Get The Led Out” programs.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Koloski to adopt Resolution 2022-27 Drinking Water State Revolving Loan Fund & ARPA Grant

Mayor Girard opened the public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Councilor Contois read resolution 2022-27 into record.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2022-28 Clean Water State Revolving Loan Fund & ARPA Grant – Public Hearing

WHEREAS, the City operates the Wastewater Treatment Plant at 338 Plains Road and wishes to replace aging and inefficient sludge dewatering equipment; and

WHEREAS, the City wishes to improve operating conditions and reduce total volume of final dewatered sludge for disposal; and

NOW, therefore be it resolved by the City Council to authorize the City manager, or his designees, to take such actions as may be necessary to file an application on behalf of the City for a loan from the State Revolving Fund (SRF) in the amount of up to \$3,163, 300 in accordance with New Hampshire RSA 486:14 and Code of Administrative Rules Chapter Env Wq 500; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED the City Treasurer, with the approval of the City Manager, is authorized to borrow up to \$3,163,300 from the State Revolving Fund (SRF) and to undertake all actions as may be required to accept and expend the funds to replace the sludge dewatering equipment at the Wastewater Treatment Plant; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to raise and appropriate the amount of up to \$3,163,300 to design and construct the Project, with up to \$3,163,300 to come from the proceeds of said SRF loan (to have no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED by the City Council to authorize the city manager, or his designees, to take such actions as may be necessary to file an application on behalf of the City for a grant from the American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) 2021 Grant Program in the amount of up to \$1,355,700.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all action and execute all documents, including the loan agreement and grant agreement, related to this resolution, and the city treasurer is hereby authorized to act on behalf of the Sewer Enterprise Fund by signing monetary disbursement (2/3 Vote Required)

Kristen Lemasney entered City Council via Zoom to Share a PowerPoint presentation to discuss the wastewater project that has attractive financial grant funding associated with it. Ms. Lemasney stated the offer for funding expires in June.

Councilor Koloski asked if there is still some life left in the current equipment, and if it could be sold for parts or entirety to another city. Ms. Lemasney stated the equipment is only good for twenty years, and noted it is possible to add into the contract to sell or salvage some equipment but the value would not be enough to build into the estimated product cost.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Koloski to adopt Resolution 2022-28 Clean Water State Revolving Loan Fund & ARPA Grant.

Councilor Contois read resolution 2022-28 into record.

Mayor Girard opened the public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

IAFF Contract/Authorize City Manager to Execute

I move that the Claremont City Council approve a Collective Bargaining Agreement between the City of Claremont and IAFF, Local 1571 (Fire Union), which calls for the following increases in salary and benefits:

Year	Estimated Increase
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FY 2023	\$14,511.67
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Said sums represent the additional costs attributable to the increase in salaries and benefits, over those of the appropriation at current staffing levels. The increase for FY 2023 shall be covered in the 2023 budget.

Mr. MacLean noted to the Council, that the Fire Union has been without contract for a while. Mr. MacLean added being very pleased to resolve this matter successfully. This is a one-year contract that recognizes the fact that the City is in a transitional period.

Mayor Girard asked when this contract goes into effect, Mr. MacLean stated there is no retro for this contract and it will start July first of this year.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to approve a Collective Bargaining Agreement between the City of Claremont and IAFF, Local 1571 (Fire Union)

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Ordinance 592 OHRV Class V Roads-First Reading

Section 1. Article X – OHRV USE ON CITY-OWNED PROPERTY

Amend Section 19-221 by permitting use of Class VI and certain identified portions of Class V roads, within the City of Claremont, by off-highway recreational vehicles for an indefinite basis from which Section 19-94 shall now provide as follows:

Sec. 19-221 – Off-highway recreational vehicles permitted.

Operation of off-highway recreational vehicles (hereinafter “OHRV” or “OHRVs”), as defined by RSA 215-A:1, ~~may shall~~ be permitted on the following portions of these Class V roads: a) 41 Cat Hole Road to 196 Cat Hole Road; b) 7 Veterans Park Road to 168 Veterans Park Road; c) the intersection of Petrin Heights Road with Washington Street to 10 Petrin Heights Road; as well as all Class VI roads, ~~and~~ bridges and certain designated/marked/specified trails ~~as set forth herein~~. OHRVs may be permitted to operate within city parks as designated subject to

such rules and regulations as are established for all users of city parks, on file in the parks and recreation department.

Section 2. Article X – OHRV USE ON CITY-OWNED PROPERTY

Amend Section 19-222 to require any maintenance, improvement and/or repair of the City's Class VI roads/trails, by any OHRV organization or club, to comply with the application and approval process set forth in Article II, Division 2 of the City's Code which shall now provide as follows:

Sec. 19-222 – Permissive use.

Each OHRV organization or club seeking to perform any maintenance, improvement and/or repair of the city's Class VI roads or trails shall obtain a permit, by and through the process as set forth in Article II, Division 2 (Sec. 16-41 through Sec. 16-58), from the department of public works prior to undertaking any such activity signed consent to use the city rights-of-ways on a form substantially similar to that recommended by the New Hampshire Bureau of Trails, which consent may be granted as is appropriate in the judgment of the city council.

Section 3. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Article X, Sections 19-221 and 19-222 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 4. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 5. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage.

City Attorney Tanguay joined City Council meeting via Zoom to explain Ordinance 592.

Mr. MacLean added the SCATV club agreed to underwrite cost of abutter notifications.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Koloski to continue Ordinance 592 Amending Article X – OHRV Use on City Owned Property to a second reading.

Councilor Contois read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mr. MacLean noted to the Council that he will be immediately working with the ATV club to make sure they get appropriate permits to do work on the trails in a timely fashion, as they need to submit these projects accordingly to the State.

Councilor Contois thanked the SCATV Club for their efforts.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Resolution 2022-29 Relocate Taxiway A - Phase 1 – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City is undertaking the continued effort to rehabilitate and improve the safety of the municipal airport infrastructure.

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, NH, will be reconstructing Taxiway “A” located between the Airport Apron and Runway 11/29. This project will go out to bid as Phase II with an expected time-line for construction in 2023

WHEREAS the City would like to now accept and expend funds;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby accepts SBG-02-25-2022, Mark, Sign, Light and Relocate Taxiway “A” – Phase I, Scope Design and Bid in the total amount of \$98,756.00.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to expend the sum of \$98,756.00 with \$4,938.00, as the City's share of the project to come from the Airport Special Revenue Fund, with \$88,800.00 as the FAA share of the project, and \$4,938.00 as the NHDOT share of the project. (to have no impact on the tax rate); and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution. (2/3 Vote Required)

Fire Chief Burr gave a brief explanation of the resolution.

A motion was made by Councilor Mooshian and seconded by Councilor Stone to adopt Resolution 2022-29 Relocate Taxiway A - Phase 1.

Councilor Mooshian read Resolution 2022-29 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Amend Merit Plan – First Reading

Section 1. Amendment to Salary/Pay Scales in Attachment C During Budgetary Process

Adopt a new Section 4 of Appendix B (Personnel Classification and Pay Schedules) to read as follows:

Section 4. Amendment to Salary/Pay Scales in Attachment C During Budgetary Process

During the City's annual budgetary review and approval process, the city's administration may submit amendment(s) to the salary/pay scales as set for in Attachment C, as previously referenced herein, for consideration by the city council as part of the proposed annual budget of the City of Claremont. In such an event, the budgetary proposal, which includes amendment(s) to the salary/pay scales in Attachment C, shall constitute an "ordinance" in accordance with sections 24, 25 and 52 of the City of Claremont Charter. In addition, the adoption of any annual budget, with such amendment(s) to these salary/pay scales, shall

comply with the procedures set forth in section 25 of the Charter. Any rejection, by vote of the city council, of any proposed amendment to the salary/pay schedules set forth in Attachment C shall not, by itself, serve as a vote against the adoption of the overall proposed annual budget of the City of Claremont for that fiscal year.

Section 2. Renumbering of Impacted Sections to Part II, Appendix B (Personnel Classification and Pay Schedules)

These sections of the prior version of Appendix B (before the adoption of this Ordinance) shall be assigned new numerical designations with the adoption of the proposed Section 4, as identified above, in the following manner:

<u>Previous Section Reference</u>	<u>New Section Reference</u>
Section 4. (Prior enactment superseded)	<u>Section 5.</u> (Prior enactment superseded)
Section 5. (Validity)	<u>Section 6.</u> (Validity)
Section 6. (Effective date)	<u>Section 7.</u> (Effective date)

Section 3. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to the City of Claremont Appendix B (Personnel Classification and Pay Schedules) by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 4. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 5. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage, but shall be retroactive to the first day of the month in which it is passed upon third reading.

Mayor Girard expressed concern with this Ordinance coming forward at budget time. Mayor Girard stated he was curious as to why the Ordinance needed to be changed if Schedule C can be brought to council regardless of approving this Ordinance.

Human Resource Manager, Samantha Lauzon stated outside of the budget process appendix C can be brought to Council for amendment. However, the thought process was that the pay scales should be looked at annually, this Ordinance would afford to do so during the budget

process.

A motion was made by Councilor Mooshian and seconded by Councilor Limoges to move Ordinance 593 Amending Appendix B Personnel Classification and Pay Schedules to a second reading/ public hearing.

Councilor Mooshian read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Mr. MacLean thanked the Council for their consideration to the amendment and stated there are two more hearings to go. Mr. MacLean also noted it has been reviewed by PAB and they have no concerns.

BUDGET

Preliminary Budget Discussions

Mr. MacLean introduced the budget workshop for the Council, and made note that the pandemic has produced revenues that are no longer available. As a result, improvements need to be made such as tax rates relative to inflation and market conditions.

Mr. MacLean explained to Council that the budget was created by Ms. Richmond with help of Mary Walter. Mr. MacLean remarked the Finance Director did wonderful job.

Mr. MacLean did note a discrepancy on the transmittal letter. On page 20 of the budget book the budget proposes a level funded tax rate, he stated this was an inadvertent error.

Ms. Richmond stated inflation is a key word and inflation is the highest it's been since December 1981.

Ms. Richmond drew the Council's attention to two figures on our estimated tax rate report. The first figure are the total expenditures. Ms. Richmond explained the total expenditures are up however, gross appropriations need to be taken into consideration. The second figure is the tax rate. Ms. Richmond explained over 9 different projections of this budget were created to reach

Council goals of paving and keeping the tax rate as low as can be.

1. Department heads request additional funds, if taking all of these additional funds to the original budget, this would be an \$8.62 increase on the tax rate. Which would bring the rate up to \$23.88
2. Budgeting the budget for the full cost of loss of purchase power, this would add \$4.21 to the tax rate making it \$19.47
3. Projections with one million dollars in paving, thirty-one thousand dollars in sidewalks, and \$186,103 for the TAP grant match, and GASB liability. This would increase the tax rate \$1.68 making the rate \$16.94
4. If adding only the one million in paving this would increase the tax rate by \$1.33 making it 16.59
5. If only adding the TAP grant match this would increase the tax rate by \$0.25, making the tax rate \$15.51
6. If only adding the GASB liability (\$50,000) this would increase the tax rate by \$0.07 making the tax rate \$15.33
7. Fund Balance-Ms. Richmond explained if the \$700,000 is not being utilized and is removed this, the tax rate would be \$16.19
8. If only using \$500,000 like last year from the Fund Balance, our tax rate would be \$15.53
9. If the Transfer Station generated another \$120,821 in income, it would be net zero on the tax rate. Which would drop the tax rate \$0.17, making the new tax rate \$15.09

Ms. Richmond explained the TAP grant. Where we would receive more than \$800,000 in sidewalks, rail trails and pedestrian paths. Transportation Alternative Program has a match, Ms. Richmond proposed utilizing the Muni-transport fund for this match. Which is the \$5.00 fee everyone pays while registering their car, this was established in 2006.

Muni transport fund has a dedicated revenue source and as of today there is \$55,835 to be added to the fund Ms. Richmond is expecting about \$67,000 to be added to the fund once this year ends.

Ms. Richmond went on to explain the GASB liabilities or our 'compensated absences' which includes all sick and vacation time that are on the books. This does not show in the budget. Ms. Richmond noted the alternative plan is using the return of surplus from Health Trust. The City received this money and paid the employees and retirees their entitled portion. Currently, there is \$177,000 of unanticipated revenue.

Ms. Richmond proposed bonding for Public Works paving. Ms. Richmond noted we bonded 1.5 million dollars for the roads in 2016, this bond is retiring, the new paving bond would replace it.

Assessing

Steve Hamilton addressed the Council on rapidly changing conditions and is seeking approval for the Assessing budget. Mr. Hamilton noted the highest costs are personnel and contractor services.

Councilor Stone questioned if assessing staff had increased, it was explained there is a shared employee where 90% of that positions cost comes out of assessing.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the Assessing Budget for \$251,372.00.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Welfare

Suzanne Carr addressed the Council seeking approval for the Welfare budget and gave an overview of the department. Ms. Carr noted the biggest expense is rental assistance and housing.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Contois to tentatively approve the Welfare Budget for \$393,897.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

O'Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Library

Michael Grace described to the Council challenges of the past couple years. Mr. Grace noted a Long-time employee retired, sadly lost an employee to sickness, and multiple employees lost due to Covid or Covid related issues.

Councilor Stone asked Mr. Grace if any programs relative to grants for books were available. Mr. Grace replied there is the Cliff Foundation for children's books. However, not many are received, Mr. Grace also noted the library sometimes receives book donations.

Councilor Stone asked if the library was fully staffed, Mr. Grace explained there is one full time and one part time position open.

Councilor Beliveau noted training and development seemed low, and would like to see this come back.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the Library Budget for \$412,132.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Elections

Ms. Richmond explained there was an increase to the voting machine and equipment along with an increase to postage cost.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Elections Budget for \$15,400.00.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0

Debt Retirement (Debt Service)

Ms. Richmond explained that debt retirement is all of the existing bonds with their principal and interest payments.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Debt Retirement (Debt Service) Budget for \$1,114,950.00

Roll call:

Contois - yes
Stone - yes
Matteau - yes
Koloski - yes
Limoges - yes
Beliveau - yes
Mooshian - yes
Girard - yes
Motion carried 8-0

Policy

Ms. Richmond explained to Council the Policy budget and added within this budget is 10% of the shared employee cost with assessing. Ms. Richmond noted there has been changes in staffing and different insurance requirements. Some former staff have done a buyout of their insurance which is substantially lower than providing the premium which will increase to health insurance cost. Majority of line items have stayed the same.

Councilor Beliveau noted the print, publish, and advertise was almost doubled of what was spent last year and, suggested only using \$8,000 for this line item. Ms. Richmond explained the high cost of advertisements in newspapers, publishing costs continue to rise. Ms. Richmond also noted the Muni-code codification that contain the City Ordinances, it was also explained that the online code hosting cost went up along with admin support fees.

Mayor Girard questioned why our assessing budget went up \$35,000, but the regular pay line didn't increase much. Ms. Richmond explained previously that 90% of cost for the shared employee was in the 411 budget, now that cost is in Assessing. Ms. Richmond noted the additional cost for the new City Manager.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Policy Budget for \$613,622.00.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

Outside Agency Request

Ms. Richmond explained this budget is the \$30,000 for the community transport services.

Councilor Stone asked what other communities contribute to them. Ms. Richmond noted Southwestern sends over their financials, and Ms. Richmond will gather this information.

Councilor Koloski noted Southwestern typically gives the Council a presentation and report on their services. Councilor Koloski added he was not in favor of this budget and was hoping for a decrease in cost.

Councilor Stone recommended not tentatively approving this budget until May 25th. The outside agency request expense was tabled until May 25th.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Contois noted the Conservation Commission will hold the Stevens Brook Monitoring on Saturday May 14th at 9am.

Councilor Stone noted the Policy Committee will meet again on June 7th, as the meeting next week has been canceled for a non-public meeting.

Assistant Mayor Matteau updated that the Planning Board approved two site plans. An expansion for fly fishing by building a new warehouse. The second was Mike Lemieux's storage units across from the train station.

Mayor Girard noted wonderful work from Fire Chief Burr and Pine Hill construction relative to the airport.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked for a list of road paving projects for this season. Specific roads that will be paved and which bids have gone out for FY22. Ms. Richmond will gather this information.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 9:22 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Beliveau to adjourn.

Roll call:

Contois - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Beliveau - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council